



LANE COUNTY • SELLING YOUR HOME • FALL 2026

From start to *sold*

Selling a home here means a lot of decisions on a deadline, and most of the stress comes from not knowing what happens next. This guide walks you through every step in order: the price, the prep, the market, the offer, the Oregon paperwork, and closing day, so you always know what is coming.



5

BUSINESS DAYS EARNEST MONEY IS TYPICALLY DUE AFTER ACCEPTANCE

10

BUSINESS DAYS A BUYER TYPICALLY HAS TO INSPECT

30-45

DAYS FROM ACCEPTED OFFER TO CLOSING ON A TYPICAL LANE COUNTY CONTRACT



01 · WELCOME

Hi, I'm Larissa, and I believe in *home*

Home is more than a physical space. It is where you have made countless memories, shared moments with the people you love, and where you feel most comfortable. So when it comes time to sell and begin a new chapter, the process can feel overwhelming. Selling a home can be an emotional journey, and it is understandable to feel apprehensive.

Rest assured that together, we can make it feel easy. I will outline the process and make a plan with you, so you do not have to do any of the heavy lifting. With my team at The Operative Group behind me, I handle finding the right buyers, negotiating the best terms for you, and getting you to a smooth close. This booklet is your guide. Keep it handy, write in it, and text me whenever a page raises a question.

Larissa Mayfield · The Operative Group · Real Broker





02 · THE PATH

Ten steps, in the *order* they happen

1. **Listing consultation.** We talk through your goals, your timeline and what you hope to net, and I show you what is selling, and not selling, near you.
2. **Set the price and sign.** We choose a price from real sales, then sign the listing agreement and start your Oregon disclosure paperwork.
3. **Get the home ready.** Repairs worth doing, decluttering, cleaning and staging.
4. **Photo and video day.** Professional photos, a walk-through video and a 3-D tour.
5. **Go live.** The listing hits the MLS and the big home search sites, and the marketing starts.
6. **Showings and open houses.** Buyers come through, and I report back on what they say.
7. **Offers.** We review every offer together, negotiate, and accept the one that fits you best.
8. **Inspection and appraisal.** The buyer inspects, we handle any repair requests, and the lender confirms the value.
9. **Title and closing prep.** The title company clears the way, and you get ready to move.
10. **Close on the house, and celebrate.** You sign, the deed records, and the proceeds are yours.

Every step has a deadline written into your contract. I track every one of them so you never have to.

Text 541.784.7745 to book your consultation →



PART ONE

Before you *list*

The plan, the price, and the house itself. Most of what decides your result happens before a single buyer walks in.





03 · THE LISTING CONSULTATION

This is where we make a *plan*

I will ask about your goals for selling and any worries you have about the sale. Take a few minutes to think about these before we meet, so we spend our time on what matters most to you:

- **What is your moving timeline?**
- **What do you hope to net from the sale?**
- **What concerns do you have about listing, or about buying your next place?**

Write them down and bring them. I will bring a comparative market analysis that shows what is selling and not selling near you, a plan for marketing your home, and an honest walk-through of what is worth fixing.

04 · WHAT I DO FOR YOU

Your broker works for *you*

When you list with me, I owe you real duties under Oregon law: loyalty, care, confidentiality, disclosure and a proper accounting of every dollar and document. Your bottom line, your reasons for moving and how flexible you are on price stay between us.

Oregon law also requires me to be honest with every buyer and to disclose material defects I know about. That is one more reason to tell me everything up front. Problems we know about early are problems we can price, fix or explain. Problems a buyer finds on their own cost more.

Before we sign anything you will get Oregon's initial agency disclosure pamphlet, which explains these relationships in the state's own words.

How I am paid. My fee is set in writing in our listing agreement, and it is negotiable. Since August 2024, what a seller offers a buyer's broker no longer appears on the MLS.

Whether to offer anything to the buyer's broker is your choice. We can share it outside the MLS, or decide when a buyer asks for it in an offer. Either way, you approve every dollar in writing before you sign.



05 • SETTING THE PRICE

Overpriced homes get *nothing*

You know what happens when you overprice your house? Nothing. No showings get scheduled, and no offers come in.

Pricing is the most important decision you will make when you go to market. I build the number from homes that have actually sold near you, adjusted for what makes yours different, not from what is still sitting unsold.

- **Buyers search by price band, not by street.** If you are \$20,000 above where the market says you should be, the buyers shopping for your home never see it. The buyers who do see it are comparing it to homes with another bedroom or another acre.
- **The first two weeks matter most.** That is when a listing gets the most attention. Price it right and you spend that window creating competition. Price it high and you spend it getting passed over.
- **A price cut does not reset the clock.** Days on market keep counting, and buyers can see the price history.

06 • THE OVERPRICING MATH

What "a little high" really *costs*

"We can always come down" sounds safe. It is not free. Try it with your own numbers:

\$	X	=
YOUR MORTGAGE, TAXES, INSURANCE AND UTILITIES, PER MONTH	THE EXTRA MONTHS YOU EXPECT TO SIT BEFORE A PRICE CUT	WHAT "A LITTLE HIGH" ACTUALLY COSTS YOU

That is the carrying cost, and it is separate from the other cost: a home that sits starts to look like something is wrong with it, even when nothing is. The home priced right the first time usually nets more than the home that chases the market down.



Bring me your real monthly numbers and we will run this together before we pick a price.

Text 541.784.7745 to run your numbers →

07 • WHAT TO FIX

Spend where it *shows*

Not every repair pays for itself before a sale. A rough rule that holds up:

USUALLY WORTH DOING

USUALLY NOT WORTH DOING
BEFORE LISTING

Fresh paint in neutral tones

A full kitchen or bath remodel

Decluttering and a deep clean

Replacing a roof that has real life left in it

Fixing anything that drips, sticks or does not work: doors, faucets, outlets, lights

New finishes a buyer will likely change anyway

Curb appeal: a mowed lawn, a working porch light, a clean front door

Landscaping beyond basic tidiness

Anything an inspector would flag anyway, like a loose railing or a missing GFCI outlet

Cosmetic work in rooms buyers barely use

Two things Oregon requires when you sell:

- **Smoke and carbon monoxide alarms.** Oregon requires working smoke alarms, and carbon monoxide alarms in a home with a carbon monoxide source like a gas appliance, wood stove or attached garage. Test them now.
- **Wood stoves.** Oregon requires an uncertified wood stove or fireplace insert to be removed and destroyed when a home is sold. Some stoves are exempt. If you have one, let's check its certification label before we list.

Thinking about a pre-listing inspection? For an older home, or a rural one, it can pay to know before buyers do. You can fix what matters, price in the rest, and avoid surprises in



the middle of the deal. Keep in mind that anything it finds becomes something you know, and it goes on your disclosure.

08 · ROOM BY ROOM

Getting it *ready* for photos

Buyers need to picture their own life in your home. That means less of yours on display.

Room by room:

ROOM	WHAT TO DO
Kitchen	Clear every counter, from plants to paper towels to the toaster. Put away personal items. Tidy the pantry
Living areas	Put away personal items and photos. Declutter, including furniture if a room feels full. Remove extra pillows
Bedrooms	Take 30% of what is in each closet out. Put away personal items. Swap bright bedding for neutral tones if you can
Bathrooms	Clear the counters of products. Put away personal items. Swap bright towels and rugs for white ones
Back yard	Pack away as many toys as you can. Trim the bushes, mow, and rake any gravel
Front entry	Sweep the porch and add a welcome mat. Plant a few potted flowers. Keep the lawn mowed
Throughout	Wipe down the blinds. Touch up drywall and paint

Start packing now. Anything you will not need for the next two months can go in boxes, and every box you pack is one less thing to move later.



Tell the *truth*, in writing

Most Oregon sellers must give buyers a Seller's Property Disclosure Statement, a form set by state law. It asks about the title, water, sewer or septic, the structure, systems, permits and more, and you answer each question yes, no or unknown, based on what you actually know.

- **Answer from what you know.** You are not expected to inspect your own house. If you do not know, "unknown" is an honest answer. Guessing is not.
- **The buyer can back out after reading it.** A buyer has five business days after receiving your disclosure to revoke their offer, unless they waive that right. If the form is never delivered, the right to revoke can last until closing. That is why I like yours finished before we list, so it goes out early and the clock starts early.
- **A few sales are exempt**, such as some estate and trust sales. I will tell you if yours is.
- **If something changes**, a leak, a new crack, a failed system, tell me right away.

Homes built before 1978. Federal law requires a lead-based paint disclosure, any reports or records you have, and a government pamphlet for the buyer. The buyer also gets up to 10 days to test for lead, unless they waive it.

Homes on a domestic well. Oregon requires the seller to have the well tested at sale for arsenic, nitrates and total coliform bacteria, give the results to the buyer, and send them to the Oregon Health Authority. We book that test early, so the results are ready when a buyer asks.

Honest, complete disclosure protects you long after closing. Fill it in with me, not alone.

Ask me to go through it with you →



Wells, septic and the *rest* of the land

Out here, the parts of a property you cannot see from the driveway are the parts buyers ask about first. Getting ahead of them is the difference between a calm inspection period and a renegotiation.

- **The well.** Beyond the required water test, buyers often order a flow test and an inspection of the pump and pressure tank. Find your well log, any past water tests and any service records. The state keeps logs for most wells, and I can look yours up.
- **The septic system.** Gather your permit and pumping records. County records show what was approved, including how many bedrooms the system was sized for. If it has not been pumped in a few years, plan on it.
- **Outbuildings.** Shops, barns, studios and second dwellings raise one question: were they permitted? Pull what permits you have. An unpermitted building is not the end of a sale, but it belongs on the table before an offer, not after.
- **Access and easements.** Is your road public, private or shared, and who maintains it? A road maintenance agreement, if you have one, saves a buyer and their lender a lot of worry.
- **Water rights and irrigation.** If you irrigate from a creek, pond or a well beyond household use, find any water rights paperwork.
- **Farm or forest tax deferral.** If your land is taxed under a farm or forest special assessment, tell me. Buyers need to know, and the contract should say who pays if the deferral ends.

These are disclosure items, not staging items. A real issue costs less when you raise it than when the buyer's inspector finds it.



PART TWO

On the *market*

Photos, launch day, marketing and showings. This is where buyers decide whether your home is worth a Saturday.





You only get one first *impression*

Online, the first impression is not just about the home. It is about how a buyer imagines they would feel living in it. That is why I use professional photography and video on every listing, and why photo day matters so much.

Photo day is an all-day event. We stage and clean first, then shoot photos, a walk-through video and a 3-D tour. Plan to be gone for most of the day.

Launch day. I like to go live on a Thursday, so the listing is fresh when weekend buyers start looking. That means cleaning and photos happen the week before.

WHEN

WHAT HAPPENS

Two to three weeks out	Repairs, decluttering and packing. Disclosure paperwork finished
The week before launch	Deep clean, staging, and photo and video day
A few days before	Photos edited, listing written, marketing pieces built. A sign goes up if we use a coming-soon period
Launch day, Thursday	Live on the MLS and the big search sites. Social posts and ads go out
First or second weekend	Open house
Every week after	Showing feedback, activity numbers and a call from me

If we use a coming-soon period, MLS rules decide what it allows, including whether showings can happen before the listing is live. I will walk you through the options before we choose.



Seen many *times*, in many places

Buyers rarely decide after one look. My marketing puts your home in front of them several times, in several places, so by the time they walk in, they already know it.

1. **Mailers.** I know, most agents will tell you these are a waste of time and money, but my data tells me otherwise. This is where we let the whole neighborhood know about your home. Four postcards follow it through: Just Listed, Open House, Under Contract and Sold.
2. **Social.** A buyer sees the postcard, then a reel about the same house, then an ad. Finally they click through to your home's own website and take the full digital tour.
3. **Open house.** That invites them to see it in person. Since they have already seen the photos and video, they walk in invested.

And the basics, done properly. Your listing goes on the MLS and out to the major search sites like Zillow and Realtor.com. I claim those listings so I can track how many people are viewing and saving your home, and I share those numbers with you.

Every ad and post describes the home and the land, and is shown to every buyer. Fair housing law is part of how I market, not an afterthought.



Making it *easy* to say yes

Every showing is a buyer deciding whether your home could be theirs. Small things help:

- **Leave during showings.** Buyers talk more openly, and stay longer, when the owner is not home.
- **Lights on, blinds open.** Set the thermostat comfortably, and do a quick tidy before you go.
- **Pets out or crated.** Tell me about them, so showing instructions can say so.
- **Lock away the valuables.** Jewelry, cash, prescriptions, firearms, mail and personal papers.
- **Cameras.** If you have doorbell or indoor cameras, tell me so we can note them in the showing instructions. Oregon law restricts recording people's conversations without telling them, so switch off audio recording.
- **Feedback.** I follow up after every showing and pass along what buyers say, good and bad.

Open houses put your listing back in front of buyers on every search site, and give them a chance to experience your home in person. We usually hold one the first weekend the home is live, or the second. Someone who walks in out of curiosity can end up being your buyer.

A home that is easy to see gets seen. Say yes to as many showings as you can, especially in the first two weeks.

Questions about showings? Text me →



PART THREE

From offer to *closing*

The negotiation, the inspection, the appraisal, the title work and the day you hand over the keys.





Comparing them side by *side*

Whenever an offer comes in, we sit down together and go through it. If there are several, we review them all at once, side by side, rather than one at a time. Price matters most, but it is not the only thing that matters:

TERM	WHAT I LOOK AT
Price	The headline number, and what it means for your net
Financing	Cash, conventional, FHA, VA or USDA, how much the buyer is putting down, and a lender's pre-approval. I ask for one with every financed offer before we respond
Earnest money	How much, and how soon it is delivered
Contingencies	How long the inspection period is, and whether the offer depends on an appraisal, a loan or the sale of the buyer's own home
Dates	When they want to close and take possession, and whether that fits your move
Requests	Help with closing costs, payment toward their broker, items they want left behind

Your choices on each offer: accept it, reject it, or counter. A counteroffer is a new offer, and the buyer can accept it, reject it or counter back. In a multiple-offer situation we can ask every buyer for their best terms, or counter more than one, with careful wording. I will explain what each choice risks before you sign anything.

Back-up offers. If a second buyer wants your home, we can accept their offer as a back-up. It moves up automatically if the first deal falls apart.



15 · UNDER CONTRACT

The first week, and the *contingencies*

Once you accept, the contract goes to the title company, a neutral party that holds the money and gathers everything needed to close.

1. **Earnest money.** The buyer delivers it to the title company, usually within a few business days.
2. **Your disclosure.** If the buyer has not already received it, it goes out now, and their five-business-day revocation window starts.
3. **Title opens.** The title company searches the record and issues a preliminary title report.

A contingency is a condition the contract depends on. The common ones:

- **Inspection.** Often 10 business days for the buyer to inspect and decide.
- **Financing.** The buyer's loan has to come through.
- **Appraisal.** Usually part of the financing: the home has to appraise for the price.
- **Sale of the buyer's home.** Some buyers need to sell first. This one comes with its own paperwork and dates.

16 · INSPECTIONS AND REPAIR REQUESTS

When the buyer looks *closely*

The buyer's inspector will find things. They always do, even in new homes. What matters is how we respond.

THE BUYER ASKS FOR

YOUR OPTIONS

Repairs

Agree to some, all or none. Agreed repairs are done by licensed contractors, with receipts for the buyer

A credit at closing

Often simpler than repairs, and it lets the buyer fix things their way

A lower price

Weigh it against what the repair would really cost, and what a relist would cost you



THE BUYER ASKS
FOR

YOUR OPTIONS

Nothing at all It happens, and that is a good day

If you cannot agree, the buyer can usually end the contract within the inspection period and get their earnest money back. Keep in mind that if this buyer walks away, what you learned from their report is now something you know, and your next disclosure has to reflect it.

My job here is to keep the conversation about the real cost of the problem, not the scariest line in the report.

Text me the moment a request comes in →

17 · THE APPRAISAL

When the value comes *back*

If the buyer is financing, their lender orders an appraisal to confirm the home is worth the price. You can help: give me a list of improvements, with dates and costs, and I will make sure the appraiser has it, along with the sales that support our price.

THE APPRAISAL IS

WHAT USUALLY HAPPENS

At or above the price The loan moves forward. Nothing changes

Below the price We can lower the price, the buyer can cover the difference in cash, we can meet in the middle, or we can ask the lender to reconsider the value with better comparable sales

Well below, with no agreement A buyer with an appraisal or financing contingency may be able to end the contract and get their earnest money back



The *paperwork* behind the keys

- **The preliminary title report** shows liens, easements and anything else recorded against the property. Old liens, a co-owner who has passed away, a divorce, or a house held in a trust can all be solved, but they take time. Tell me early.
- **Who signs.** Everyone on title signs. If someone will sign with a power of attorney, the title company needs to approve it ahead of time.
- **Title insurance.** In Oregon the seller customarily pays for the buyer's owner's title policy. The buyer pays for the lender's policy.
- **Escrow.** The escrow fee is commonly split evenly between buyer and seller here.
- **The deed.** Most Oregon sales close with a statutory warranty deed.
- **No transfer tax here.** Oregon has no state real estate transfer tax, and Lane County charges none. Washington County is the one exception in the state. You will pay small recording and document fees.
- **Property taxes.** Oregon's tax year runs July 1 to June 30. Taxes are split at closing: if you have already paid the year, the buyer pays you back for the days after closing.
- **If you live outside Oregon, or outside the U.S.** Oregon may require the title company to hold back part of your proceeds for state income tax, and the federal FIRPTA rules can require a buyer to withhold up to 15% from a foreign seller. Tell me at the start so the title company can plan for it.
- **Taxes on your gain.** Many sellers who have lived in their home two of the last five years owe little or nothing on the gain, but every situation is different. Talk to your tax professional before you list.



What you *walk away* with

The sale price is not what lands in your account. Here is how the title company gets from one to the other. Fill in what you know, and I will give you a real estimate with the rest.

LINE	WHAT IT IS	YOUR NUMBER
Sale price	The agreed price in your contract	
Minus mortgage payoff	Every loan and line of credit on the property, plus interest to the day it pays off. Your lender sends the title company an exact figure	
Minus listing broker	What we agree to in the listing agreement	
Minus buyer's broker	Only if you offer it or agree to it in an offer	
Minus owner's title policy	Customarily the seller's cost in Oregon, priced from the title company's filed rates	
Minus half the escrow fee	Commonly split evenly with the buyer	
Minus recording and document fees	Small county and title charges	
Minus or plus property taxes	Your share of the July to June tax year. If you paid ahead, the buyer credits you back	
Minus repairs and credits	Anything agreed after inspection	
Minus other costs	Well test, HOA transfer or document fees, liens or judgments, a home warranty if you offer one	



LINE

WHAT IT IS

YOUR
NUMBER

Estimated net

Before moving costs and any tax on your gain

Know your number before you list, not at the closing table.

Text 541.784.7745 for your net estimate →

20 · MOVING OUT AND CLOSING DAY

Handing over the *keys*

Before you move

- **Possession** happens on the date and time in your contract. Book movers around it. If you need a few more days, we can negotiate a rent-back in writing.
- **What stays.** Anything attached to the house, like light fixtures and window coverings, usually stays unless the contract says otherwise. If there is something you want to take, tell me before we list, so we exclude it or swap it out now.
- **Utilities.** Schedule final readings for closing day, with EWEB, SUB or whoever serves you. Do not cancel early, and keep your insurance until the deed records.
- **Leave it ready.** Broom clean, with everything you are taking gone. Leave keys, garage remotes, gate codes, manuals and warranties.

Closing day

I have done this dozens of times, and I promise you, we will get through it just fine. You will be signing a lot of paperwork, most of it pretty dull, all of it important. The good news is, it is all paperwork we will have already reviewed.

1. **You sign** at the title company, usually a day or two before the official closing date. We go through your closing statement line by line first.
2. **The deed records.** After everyone signs and the buyer's loan funds, the title company sends the deed to the county to record. It is not official until it records.
3. **Your proceeds are released** by wire or check once the deed records.
4. **The keys go to the new owner**, on the possession date in your contract.



Wire fraud targets sellers' proceeds too. Give your bank details only to the title company, by phone, at a number you looked up yourself. If instructions ever change by email or text, even from me, stop and call.

Save my number: 541.784.7745 →

21 · WHAT YOU CAN EXPECT

My *promise* to you

I know this is about more than selling high and buying low. I can promise you that while there will be some bumps along the way, I will be doing my best to help you avoid any delays or roadblocks.

You can expect weekly phone calls with my trademark tell-it-like-it-is honesty, and creative problem solving to get you where you want to go.

22 · WHAT CLIENTS SAY

In their *words*

*Larissa is amazing! We sold our rural home with Larissa and had to move a good distance away or we would have used her for the buying process of our new house. She was professional, transparent, thorough, and very organized. She checked in with us often, if not daily. If there were any hiccups, she handled them quick and kept us in the loop at all times. I've bought 3 houses and this sale could not have gone smoother thanks to Larissa. **The Rossen family***

*Relocating my family member from another city was an overwhelming prospect. Thankfully we found Larissa and she made this all possible. From selling the first house to buying the second, she gave us countless hours of actual practical advice. **The Garneau family***

I won't use anyone else other than Larissa in the future. For 3 years, she sent me homes as I sat back waiting for the market to go back to normal. When I did get an offer accepted on a house, she worked hard to make sure all the bumps were



*fixed 7 days a week. However, when I got laid off 2 days before closing, she called in favors to see if we could save the deal. She is top notch and has earned my loyalty. **The Hunt family***

*Larissa did an amazing job guiding us through the purchase of our first home. She was very professional and responded quickly to all my questions. I would highly recommend using her to buy or sell your next home! **The Harwood family***



23 · YOUR PRE-LISTING CHECKLIST

Get *ahead* of it

Work through this before photo day. Every item checked here is one less question in the middle of your sale.

PAPERWORK TO GATHER

DONE

Mortgage statements, and any home equity line

Your latest property tax statement

HOA contact and documents, if you have one

Utility providers and typical monthly bills

Receipts and dates for big items: roof, furnace or heat pump, water heater, windows

Permits for additions, remodels, shops and outbuildings

Well log, past water tests, septic permit and pumping records

Survey, easements and any road maintenance agreement

Warranties and manuals that stay with the house

Trust, estate, power of attorney or divorce paperwork, if any of it applies

THE HOUSE

DONE

Smoke and carbon monoxide alarms tested and working

Wood stove certification label checked



THE HOUSE

DONE

30% of every closet packed away

Counters cleared and personal photos put away

Deep clean, blinds wiped, paint touched up

Drips, sticky doors and dead bulbs fixed

Lawn mowed, porch swept, welcome mat out

Valuables, prescriptions and firearms locked away

A plan for pets during showings

Spare keys, remotes and codes gathered

24 · WHAT TO DO NEXT

Your first *three* steps

1. **Run the overpricing math** on page 06 with your real monthly numbers.
2. **Start your checklist**, beginning with the paperwork. It takes longer to find than you think.
3. **Text me.** We will sit down for a listing consultation, walk the house together, and I will show you what is actually selling near you and what I think your home will bring.

There is no pressure and no obligation in that first conversation. Just questions, answered honestly, so you can decide when you are ready.

Text 541.784.7745, or find me at larissamayfieldre.com. I work with The Operative Group at Real Broker, LLC, so there is a whole team behind your sale, and one person, me, who answers your texts.